

Cafe Yi

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Public Sector Advisory | Service, System Design & Delivery

Summary

I am a public sector advisory, service design and complex delivery professional with 18+ years of experience across digital services, accessibility, information architecture, stakeholder engagement and built environment delivery. I help teams clarify complex problems, connect user evidence with delivery constraints, and turn service ideas into implementation ready outcomes.

My recent public sector work includes leading the creation and testing of the NZ Police Victim Hub, where I owned scope definition, stakeholder engagement, research, information architecture, prototyping, comparative usability testing and delivery handover. My earlier career in public buildings and civic environments shaped my systems thinking approach to accessibility, public value and long term service delivery.

Key Skills

- Public sector advisory, problem framing and evidence informed recommendations
- Service and system design, accessibility focused pathways and information architecture
- Stakeholder engagement, workshop facilitation and cross functional alignment
- Research synthesis, usability testing, evaluation thinking and insight to action translation
- Work programme coordination, risk management, reporting and implementation readiness
- Complex delivery, vendor coordination, quality assurance and multidisciplinary leadership
- Research operations, dashboard style workflow design and structured evidence collection

Selected Experience

Principal Advisor | Ministry of Justice, New Zealand | Mar 2026 to Jun 2026, fixed term

- Led the end to end creation and testing of the NZ Police Victim Hub under the Justice Sector Directorate Victims Programme.
- Owned scope definition, stakeholder engagement, risk management, communication, reporting and delivery handover within a short fixed term delivery window.
- Restructured fragmented victim related information into a clearer pathway and dedicated entry point on the NZ Police website.
- Applied research, information architecture, prototyping and comparative usability testing, showing measurable improvements in task success, ease of use and completion time.
- Used testing findings to define a focused iteration priority around clearer “what happens next” content, rather than recommending a full redesign.

Deputy Director | ADG Studio, Guangdong Architectural Design and Research Institute Group Co. Ltd. | Jan 2024 to Jan 2025

- Served as deputy team lead for a 20 member multidisciplinary design team, overseeing project operations, workforce planning, resourcing, governance, stakeholder communication, employee training and technical recruitment.
- Managed operational planning and delivery coordination across active project work and proposal initiatives, supporting alignment with strategic direction and annual output targets.
- Completed 34 design projects, including one shortlisted proposal and three winning bids, while contributing to average output value of NZD 1.6 million per person and 8.3 percent year on year growth.
- Coordinated outsourced specialist vendors and consultants, including model making, rendering, facade and lighting consultants. Clarified scope, contract details, deliverable requirements, timelines and quality expectations while monitoring progress and resolving delivery issues.

Deputy Chief Architect | ADG Studio, Guangdong Architectural Design and Research Institute Group Co. Ltd. | Mar 2009 to Mar 2024

- Progressed from Junior Architect to one of the studio's technical leads, leading concept development, cross disciplinary coordination, project planning, resource allocation, quality assurance and technical communication.
- Contributed to more than 3.4 million sqm of designed projects, including approximately 115,000 sqm of completed built work across public, transport, sports, cultural and commercial environments.
- Led teams of 10 to 15 members across concept, documentation and implementation stages, managing schedules, workflows and deliverable quality.
- Supported early planning and feasibility work for the Guangdong Disabled Persons' Sports and Arts Training Centre as an architect and planning support contributor, working with quantity surveyors to estimate accessibility facility requirements and total project costs for construction funding approval.
- Received more than 10 top tier industry design awards at national and provincial levels and contributed to professional publications and portfolio stewardship.

Selected Projects

NZ Police Victim Hub | Public Sector Digital Service | 2026

- Created a dedicated victim information channel by consolidating fragmented information into one hub and five sub pages.
- Delivered measurable improvements in the tested experience: task success increased from 66.7% to 88.9%, average ease improved from 2.67/5 to 4.17/5, and median task time reduced from 140 seconds to 82 seconds.
- Delivered implementation ready documentation, content ownership mapping and handover material for NZ Police.

Accessibility Support Hub | Service Design and Accessibility | 2025 to 2026

- Accessibility focused public service prototype for Ministry of Justice court support information.
- Led a three person UX team, supporting scope alignment, stakeholder engagement, service blueprinting, information architecture, prototyping and usability testing.
- Conducted an on-site field visit to understand actual court accessibility conditions, improving UX writing accuracy and connecting digital support pathways with the physical court experience.

Studier | Research Operations and Product Design | 2026

- Designed and built a lightweight internal research operations platform within one week to support customised usability testing for a government project.
- Created a dashboard style task management interface that allowed team members to view, create, publish and manage user-generated testing tasks.
- Supported anonymous participant response collection without identifying information and enabled structured evidence collection for testing and analysis.

Voting Starter Kit | Civic Participation and Multi-channel UX | 2025

- Designed as part of a four person UX team to help new immigrants understand why local elections matter and take the next step with confidence.
- Contributed to research synthesis, problem framing, content strategy, information architecture, UX/UI design and usability testing.
- Helped translate complex civic information into social media cards, a folded brochure and a responsive website prototype.

Selected Built Environment Work | Public Buildings and Civic Environments

- Worked across major public, transport, sports, cultural and commercial projects, with a focus on complex systems, stakeholder coordination, quality assurance and delivery across long project lifecycles.
- Built practical understanding of accessibility as part of a wider service and delivery system, including cost, construction, operation, maintenance and long term use.

Education

- Master of User Experience Design, Victoria University of Wellington, 2025 to 2026, Graduate with Distinction.
- Bachelor of Architecture, South China University of Technology, 2002 to 2007.

Certifications and Recognition

- Google Project Management, 2026. Microsoft Content Development and Management, 2026. Google AI Essentials, 2024.
- Class 1 Registered Architect of China. Professor level Senior Engineer, Architecture.
- More than 10 national and provincial industry design awards across major public, transport, sports, commercial and cultural projects.

Tools and Languages

- Tools: Figma, Miro, Microsoft Office, Microsoft Project, Microsoft Clarity, Adobe Creative Suite.
- Languages: Mandarin, native. English, professional fluency. Cantonese, professional fluency.